MUSKETEER'S KIT

Because of a lingering prejudice against firearms, the musketeer ranked below the pikeman in English Civil War infantry. He was rarely issued even with a helmet for protection, whereas pikemen often had body armour. The muskets used in the Civil War were mostly clumsy matchlocks. More advanced flintlock muskets were given only to a few specialist infantry – for example, those guarding gunpowder stores, where sparks from a match might cause an explosion. Lighter than earlier models, the matchlock did not need to be leant on a rest to fire.

Broad-brimmed hat
The hats worn by the foot soldiers in Cromwell's army were far from uniform, but were usually made of stiffened felt with a wide brim.

Soldier's red coat
The only item of uniform that was officially issued to the New Model Army was the red coat. The colour of the lining, visible in the turned-back cuffs, indicated the soldier's regiment.

Muzzle

Scouring stick, for cleaning the barrel and ramming down charge and musket ball

Priming flask

Pouch for musket balls

Leather pouch
Neither the coat nor the breeches had pockets, so soldiers carried all their personal belongings in bags and pouches.

Bandolier
Twelve wooden powder flasks were hung from the bandolier, which was worn across the chest. Each flask held a single charge. There was also a pouch for musket balls and a flask holding the finer priming powder.